

Guidance on the Guaranteed Interview Scheme for Veterans

Havant Borough Council (HBC) recognises it has a role to play in helping those leaving the Armed Forces (veterans) fulfil their potential in civilian life. Veterans can find making the transition to civilian life extremely challenging, particularly in finding and securing lasting employment.

This policy sets out how the Council supports Veterans through the recruitment process.

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1.0. Scope

- 1.1 The Guaranteed Interview Scheme for Veterans will operate for all external recruitment.
- 1.2 **Please note:** This scheme has no bearing on redeployment, redundancy selection or internal reorganisations.

2.0 Equal Opportunities

- 2.1 HBC is an equal opportunities employer and recognises that a diverse workforce, coming from all sections of the community, can improve services by offering differing skills, experiences, backgrounds and cultures. HBC also recognises the Disability Confident scheme.
- 2.2 HBC is committed to support the armed forces community in the Havant Borough area, including all serving and former members, reservists and their families. The Guaranteed Interview Scheme for Veterans stems from this commitment.

3.0 What are the benefits of the Guaranteed Interview Scheme for Veterans?

- 3.1 This Scheme has a number of benefits, including the following:

- Veterans can bring valuable transferable skills and qualities into the organisation, such as:
 - Communication skills
 - Organisational skills and commitment
 - Problem solving and adaptability
 - Leadership and management skills
 - Health and safety / security awareness
 - Team working skills
- The Scheme may provide the recruiting manager with a wider selection of candidates to appoint from, using the essential criteria listed on the role profile.
- It will assist veterans to overcome barriers in finding civilian employment.
- It will help reduce the risk of veterans developing health and welfare problems as a result of long term unemployment.
- It will contribute to the achievements of the Council's Economic and Later Life priorities, specifically in relation to developing an appropriately skilled workforce, and ensuring financial security and independence in later life.

4.0 What is a Veteran?

4.1

The MOD define a Veteran as “anyone who has served for at least one day in Her Majesty's Armed Forces (Regular or Reserve), or Merchant Mariners who have seen duty on legally defined military operations.”

5.0 What is the Guaranteed Interview Scheme for Veterans?

5.1

The Guaranteed Interview Scheme for Veterans is a commitment that HBC has made to support the Armed Forces Community Covenant. This commitment is to guarantee an interview for any veterans that meet the essential criteria set out in the role profile. The scheme is not a guaranteed job for Veterans, as selection procedures will ensure the best candidate for the job is appointed, based on the objective criteria of the role profile.

6.0 Who is eligible for a Guaranteed Interview for Veterans?

6.1 The following applicants are eligible for the Guaranteed Interview Scheme:

- Applicants that are currently serving in the Armed Forces and are within 12 weeks of their discharge date; and
- meet the essential criteria set out in the role profile

Or alternately:

- Applicants that meet the essential criteria set out in the role profile; **and**
- the Armed Forces were their last long term substantive employer; **and** • no more than 3 years has elapsed since they left the Armed Forces.

6.2 Please note: As per section 2.0 above, HBC recognises the Disability Confident scheme, and for anyone who meets the essential criteria on the person specification for the role they have applied for, they are guaranteed an interview. Please refer to the Recruitment Procedure for further information.

7.0 How will the Scheme work?

7.1 There will be minor amendments to certain areas of the recruitment process which are explained below.

7.2 Role Profiles

Before advertising, the recruiting manager needs to review the role profile and ensure that it lists all the key skills and qualifications that are essential to the role. This will ensure that shortlisting is completed in an objective way.

7.3 Advertising

All external job adverts will automatically appear on the MOD Career Transition Partnership (CTP) Right Job website and Families Forces Job portal at no extra cost to the recruiting manager/ service. This will potentially widen the pool of applications received.

7.4 Shortlisting

The recruiting manager should check the application form to see if the applicant has declared that they are a veteran. Any veteran that meets the essential criteria for the role and the Scheme **must** be offered an interview alongside other applicants that meet the essential criteria. This will ensure a veteran does not displace a candidate that meets the essential criteria, thus widening the shortlist and ensuring the equality of opportunities.

Please note: Where a veteran is classed as disabled they will be considered under the Disability Confident Scheme. For further information please refer to the Recruitment Procedure.

7.5 Interviewing

The Recruiting Manager will need to check one of the following;

- 1) The Military Service Records pack. The applicant will be required to bring their pack to their interview. There is no requirement to take and store a copy of this. This information will confirm the veteran's military service record and may be a useful demonstration of their skills and experience.
- 2) Proof of the applicant's Armed Forces discharge date, at interview. Again, there is no requirement to take and store a copy of this.

- 3) ID card for armed forces veterans, which will help them access specialist support and services, has started to be issued to service leavers.

Where a candidate has falsely claimed to be a Veteran any offer of employment may be withdrawn. Please contact Human Resources for advice before taking any action.

7.6 Feedback

Due to the number of applicants HBC receive there is no obligation to provide feedback to applicants that were **not** shortlisted. However, where possible recruiting managers will attempt to feedback to all unsuccessful interviewees.

- 7.7 Care should be taken when providing feedback to unsuccessful applicants, making sure that it is based on factual evidence from the interview notes.

- 7.8 As a first step to gaining civilian employment, veterans will be keen to receive feedback on how they have performed at interview.

Written

Bollington St. John's Church of England
Primary School



Where talent grows

Head Teacher: Mrs M. Walker
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“Whatever you do, work at it with all your heart, as working for the Lord”

Colossians 3:23

Wellbeing Policy

SCOPE

This policy is applicable to all staff at Bollington St John's.

It does not form part of any employee's contract of employment and we may amend it at any time.

POLICY STATEMENT

The purpose of this policy is to set out the school's approach to managing its obligations to support and enable staff to maintain their physical and mental health wellbeing.

The school has a responsibility for the health and wellbeing of its entire staff. As such we are committed to the fair and consistent application of a Wellbeing Policy that maintains the wellbeing of staff whilst enabling the school to deliver effective and efficient services to residents.

This policy explains:

- What you can expect from the school and what the school expects of you.
- Workplace measures to promote wellbeing, including sources of help.

This policy should be read in conjunction with the school's policies and procedures on Flexible Working, Leave and Time Off, as well as Health and Safety policies.

WHAT YOU CAN EXPECT FROM THE SCHOOL

We will:

- Seek to ensure that your mental health and wellbeing is always treated as a priority, and make sure that you are supported if you are facing such issues.
- Take all reasonable steps to provide a safe and positive working environment, and put in place measures to minimise the risks to your health and wellbeing.
- Ensure health and safety at work as set out in the Health and Safety at Work Act 1974 and the Management of Health and Safety at Work Regulations 1999.
- Provide first aid in accordance with health and safety first aid regulations, as well as mental health first aiders to support you if you are experiencing mental health problems.
- Make sure that jobs are designed fairly and that work is allocated appropriately between staff.
- Set clear performance objectives and realistic timescales for delivery.
- Be supportive towards you, and where appropriate, seek to identify ways which can assist you to improve your health and attendance in the future.
- Listen, respond and act appropriately and in a timely manner when you tell us about something that is inappropriate or wrong.

- Respect the confidentiality of all information relating to any sickness in line with the Data Protection Act 2018 and the Access to Medical Records Act 1988.
- Treat you fairly and consistently in accordance with the terms of this Policy.

WHAT THE SCHOOL EXPECTS OF YOU

We expect you to:

- Take responsibility for caring for your own health and wellbeing by adopting good health behaviours (e.g. diet, alcohol consumption and smoking).
- Follow safe and healthy working practices and procedures, and report any concerns to your manager (i.e. if you believe that work or the work environment poses a risk to your health).
- Discuss any concerns at work with your manager and/or raise any complaints through the appropriate channels (e.g. the Grievance Policy and Procedures or the school's Whistleblowing Policy).
- Tell the Headteacher if you see or experience anything that is inappropriate or wrong so that the issue or your complaint may be properly investigated in a timely manner and, if appropriate, action taken. And in the event that you are not satisfied with the outcome and response from the Headteacher, you should refer the issue up to the Chair of Governors.
- Tell your Headteacher of any extenuating circumstances (e.g. personal or family problems or an unmanageable workload which may be affecting you in work).
- Ask the Headteacher for help if you need it.

WORKPLACE MEASURES TO PROMOTE WELLBEING

The school also has a Dignity at Work policy which sets out the school's standards on how you should behave towards colleagues at work, and explain how problems associated with bullying and harassment can be resolved if they occur.

There are also a number of policies available if you have concerns at work or wish to raise a complaint (e.g. the Grievance Policy and Procedures or the school's Whistleblowing Policy).

Occupational Health

The role of the school's occupational health provider is to assess the impact of 'health on work' and 'work on health' and to help maintain the health of the workforce. It is an independent advisory service that will give impartial advice to you and your manager.

The school's occupational health provider will undertake various screening medicals, and also assessments when you find aspects of your work difficult to undertake due to health problems, or when prolonged/frequent sickness absences occur. Full contact details for the school's occupational health provider are available from the Headteacher.

Work Life Balance and Flexible Working

The school recognises that a better work-life balance can improve staff motivation, performance/productivity, and reduce stress. The school therefore has a number of policies that support you in achieving a better balance between work and other priorities such as caring responsibilities, leisure activities, further learning and other interests.

More information about work-life balance and flexible working options are available from the school. You should also speak to your manager and/or union representative for additional support and advice.

DATA PROTECTION

The school processes personal data, including information about your health, in accordance with its data protection policy. Inappropriate access or disclosure of your data constitutes a data breach and should be reported immediately in accordance with the school's data protection policy. It may also constitute a disciplinary offence, which will be dealt with under the school's disciplinary procedure.

EQUALITY

Bollington St John's is committed to promoting equal opportunities in employment. You (and any job applicants) will receive equal treatment regardless of age, disability, gender reassignment, marital or civil partner status, pregnancy or maternity, race, religion or belief, sex or sexual orientation or caring responsibility. This means that the application of the policy may need to be adjusted to cater for the specific needs of an individual including the provision of information in alternative formats where necessary.

MONITORING AND REVIEW

The policy will be monitored to ensure that it is operating fairly, consistently and effectively. The policy will also be reviewed in the light of operating experience and/or changes in legislation.

Prepared **by:** ~~Education HR~~ Department Consultancy

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